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Oilthigh na Gàidhealtachd
agus nan Eilean
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na Gàidhealtachd

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Angels is helpful, but should be approached critically. I was grateful to Dr Heiser for making me think much more purposefully and carefully about angels, and their significant place in Scripture. I have a better view of heaven, and the variety and activity of its spiritual occupants. But, absorbing as this can be, I see the danger of being distracted by this from the central message of Jesus Christ and his Gospel. Surely angels are minor characters when compared with the Patriarchs, the Prophets, the Apostles, and Jesus himself? I remain concerned at Dr Heiser's preoccupation with his subject. In addition, at times he assumes rare interpretations, for example, Genesis 1:26 ('Let us make man in our image') is a reference to the Trinity, and not, as he states, about angels helping God in his act of creation.

If you know relatively little about angels, and want to find out more, and to come to a better, informed biblical understanding of them, this book will prove helpful. However, it should be approached critically.

Andrew Anderson, Oxford

The Fundamentals of Hebrew Accents: Divisions and Exegetical Roles beyond Syntax. By Sung Jin Park. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2020. ISBN: 978-1-108-79098-7. xv + 178pp. £26.99.

In this textbook, Park examines the Tiberian Hebrew accent system (*te'amim*) as found in the 'twenty-one' prose books of the Old Testament. The book is intended for intermediate Hebrew students in an eight-week course. The Palestinian and Babylonian accent systems appear in Appendix B while he mentions the accents used in Psalms, Proverbs, and the poetic portions of Job in Appendix C. Park's volume was published in the same month as *Basics of Hebrew Accents* by M. Futato. I will compare these volumes throughout this review.

Park begins by presenting the names and symbols of the twenty-eight Tiberian accents as well as highlighting the most important. He argues that the *soph pasuq* is the disjunctive accent delineating the verse (pp. 4–5; *contra* Futato p. 28). The accents fall either on the stressed syllable (normal), before (post-positive), or after it (pre-positive). Park discusses the Hierarchy Rule (i.e., accents govern different domains) and the Dichotomy Rule (i.e., a disjunctive can be divided by another disjunctive that is in a domain lower than it) in chapter two. Chapters three and four illustrate the conditions under which disjunctive accents can be substituted to produce 'variegated musical neumes' (pp. 23, 33).

The conjunctive accents (chapter five) were not originally part of the Tiberian Hebrew accent system but developed to connect the words between disjunctive accents. Unlike the disjunctive accents, they do not

have a pattern of hierarchy. Most disjunctive accents take two or three conjunctive accents and prefer certain conjunctives.

In chapter six, Park discusses the Simplification Rule, Division Rule, Spirantisation Rule, and the Nesige Rule. According to the Simplification Rule, a conjunctive accent can replace an excessive amount of disjunctive accents to smooth the reading process. According to the Division Rule, a phrase of two words may be further divided by a disjunctive accent if one of the words is phonologically long. According to the Spirantisation Rule, a word beginning with a *begadkefat* letter ‘softens’ when preceded by a conjunctive accent but ‘hardens’ when preceded by a disjunctive (Park references Judg. 1:8 on p. 85— *wayyillāhamu* [conjunctive] *vene yehudah* [disjunctive] *birušalaim* ‘The sons of Judah fought against Jerusalem...’). Finally, according to the Nesige Rule, a *maqef* causes the stress to retract to avoid the juxtaposition of two stressed syllables.

Park examines the primary function of the disjunctive accents in chapter seven. He argues that accents do not always correspond to Hebrew syntax nor do they all mark stress. Subsequently, Park argues that Prosodic Analysis provides the proper avenue to comprehend the Tiberian accentual system. This is the study of the intonation and stress of an utterance. Prosodic analysis can be similar, but not identical, to syntactic analysis. For example, the phrases appearing in Genesis 14:12; 19:1; and 23:10 are syntactically identical (i.e., Conjunction *w* + Subject + participle of *yšb* ‘to dwell’ + *b* prepositional phrase with the object being a location) but there are different accents in each context (p. 107). Thus, the Masoretes mark the phrase differently in each case. After presenting criteria for connecting disjunctive accents and intonational phrases (p. 109), Park then tests his criteria on Isa. 1:10 (pp. 111–112). Additionally, Park includes analysis from Performance Structure which notes the boundaries of utterances. The most prominent break in an utterance is usually in the middle of the sentence and in the middle of each half sentence. This is where the disjunctive accents surface. Thus, Park suggests that accents mark the pauses for proper recitation (p. 115). He suggests that there is a general linguistic connection between intonation and musical melodies (pp. 139–140).

In the final chapter, Park argues that the Masoretic accents aids exegesis. For example, the accents clarify ambiguous meaning such as the placement of the phrase ‘in the wilderness’ in the second line of Isa. 40:3 (pp. 118–119; *contra* Futato pp. 84–86). The accents can emphasize words or phrase as does the disjunctive accent after *zo’t torat* ‘this is the law’ in Leviticus 6:2, 7; 12:7; and 15:32. This break illustrates which ‘instruction’ is under discussion (p. 121). The accents can create a dramatic effect

such as the slow-motion account of Ehud stabbing Eglon in Judges 3:21 (pp. 128–129).

This book provides a useful introduction to a neglected topic. The exercises ask the student to identify and produce the accents to aid the learning process (*contra* Futato p. 100). Park's line drawing arrangement of the accentual hierarchy of disjunctives is more illustrative than Futato's tree-diagram. There are a few minor issues with this volume. Park's presentation is at points a bit terse and unclear in the first six chapters. The first six chapters do not provide a translation of the copious Hebrew examples discussed because they focus on the Tiberian accents. A translation would have reinforced the emphasis and breaks inherent in the system (though this should not be a significance hinderance to the student). Nonetheless, this resource will help students of the Hebrew text gain an appreciation for the Tiberian accentual system.

Josiah D. Peeler, University of Edinburgh

Basics of Hebrew Accents. By Mark D. Futato, Sr. Grand Rapids, MI: Zondervan Academic, 2020. ISBN: 978-0-310-09842-3. 113pp. £10.99.

Futato provides a clear and engaging introduction to the Tiberian Hebrew accent system found in the Old Testament. His work targets the intermediate student of biblical Hebrew who has just finished an introductory grammar (p. 13). Futato's volume was published in the same month as *The Fundamentals of Hebrew Accents* by S. Park. I will compare these volumes throughout this review.

In chapter one, Futato introduces the accents, their position (impositive, prepositive, and postpositive), and their jobs. He argues that there are three jobs which accents do concurrently. They mark word stress, mark the sense of the text (i.e., syntax), and aid in chanting. Chanting is connected to the sense of the text. Thus, the phonologic stress of a word, syntax, and musical considerations work together in the accentual system. He does not believe that *soph pasuq* is a disjunctive accent (*contra* Park pp. 4–5) as it does not mark word stress or appear consistently in Hebrew manuscripts (e.g., Aleppo Codex).

Futato sketches the disjunctive accents in the next chapter. He notes that the system is 'binary' by which he means there is 'continuous dichotomy' (p. 34). The text divides into two parts from the sentence level down to the phrasal level. He divides the disjunctive accents into four groups (i.e., group one and two are major disjunctives and groups three and four are minor disjunctives) alluding to the 'kingly' terminology often utilized to describe the hierarchy of power within the disjunctive accentual system. He uses a tree-diagram to represent the various levels of division in the